MITOOMA VOCATIONAL SECONDARY SCHOOL

SCHOOL MANAGEMENT SYSTEM USER MANUAL

A practical guide for administrators and authorised school staff

Version: Preliminary guide for the separate fresh-install system
Prepared: 9 November 2026

Please read the safety and backup instructions before entering or importing school records.

Important note about this manual

This is a starter manual based on the system setup and safeguards discussed during preparation. The complete live screen-by-screen workflow has not yet been verified against the deployed fresh-install website. Button names and available modules may differ. Where a feature is not visible in your version, do not assume it is available; ask the system administrator to confirm it.

This manual does not replace the school's data-protection procedures. Only authorised staff should access student and staff information.

1. Before using the system

• Open the official school-system website supplied by the administrator.
• Use a supported, up-to-date browser where possible. The school has previously used Safari on iPhone and desktop browsers.
• Make sure the device has enough battery and, when possible, an internet connection.
• Sign in using the account or access method issued by the school. Never share passwords or access codes.
• Confirm that the school name and expected system version are shown before entering records.

2. Understanding online and offline use

The system has been designed for offline-first use. Depending on the deployed build, some pages and previously loaded data may remain available when the internet connection is lost. Changes made offline may be stored on that device and synchronised when connectivity returns.

Important: an offline change is not automatically confirmed as safely stored in the cloud. Keep the device open and connected until the system reports that synchronisation has completed. Do not assume a green or 'Synced' message proves that every other device has the same latest records.

3. Working with student records

When the student-record module is available:
1. Open the student or admissions section.
2. Search for the student before creating a new record. This helps prevent duplicates.
3. Open the correct student record and check the identifying details carefully.
4. Enter only information required by the school. Check spelling, class, admission number and contact details before saving.
5. Re-open the record after saving to confirm the change appears.
6. If you cannot find the expected student or the record looks different on another device, stop editing that record and contact the administrator.

Do not create a replacement record just because a record is temporarily missing while the device is offline or synchronising.

4. Attendance, fees, reports and other modules

The exact modules depend on the version deployed by the administrator. If your system displays attendance, fees, examinations, staff, reports or similar sections, use the instructions and permissions provided by the school for each section. Before saving a transaction or assessment, verify the student, date, class, amount or marks, and term. Recheck totals and reports before printing or sharing them.

Do not enter financial transactions, marks or attendance on behalf of another staff member unless you are authorised to do so.

5. Synchronisation and editing on more than one device

• Avoid editing the same student or the same set of records on two devices at the same time.
• If possible, agree which staff member/device is responsible for a particular batch of changes.
• After editing, allow the system to finish saving and synchronising before closing the page or switching devices.
• On the second device, refresh or reopen the system and verify that the expected change is visible before making further edits.
• If a conflict, warning, unexpected older value or missing record appears, stop editing and contact the administrator. Do not repeatedly refresh or try random recovery actions.

> The system's snapshot/chunk backup and cloud synchronisation are different things. A successful backup does not necessarily mean that all recent edits from every device have been merged.

6. Backups and recovery

The administrator should make and verify backups regularly, especially before term changes, bulk imports, deletions, upgrades or changing Firebase/GitHub settings. Keep more than one copy, and store at least one copy separately from the device used for daily work.

Before restoring a backup:
1. Stop all users from editing the system.
2. Identify the newest known-good backup and its date.
3. Make an additional copy of the current data before attempting restoration.
4. Confirm which data will be replaced and which will be retained.
5. Restore only through the approved administrator procedure.
6. Verify student counts and sample records before allowing staff to resume work.

> Never delete the old Firebase snapshot or initialise/replace a database as a troubleshooting experiment. The old live system and its recovery data must remain untouched unless the administrator has verified a separate recovery plan.

7. Administrator deployment checklist

For the separate fresh installation, the administrator should confirm all of the following before staff use it:
• The new website is in its own GitHub repository and does not replace the old live website.
• The new website uses the intended, separate Firebase project—not the old `mitooma-voc` project.
• Firebase configuration is complete and contains no placeholder values.
• Firestore is the intended database and its initial state has been checked.
• Firestore security rules restrict access appropriately; public read/write access must not be used for real student data.
• The manifest and service worker filenames match the files referenced by the website.
• Any classroom image filename and path match the website reference.
• A test backup and restore procedure has been checked before production use.

8. Common problems

System says offline: Check the device connection. Do not repeatedly submit the same change. Wait for the connection and verify the record afterwards.

Synchronisation is still checking: Keep the page open, wait, and check again. If it remains stuck, contact the administrator with the time and device/browser details.

A record is missing or appears old: Stop editing that record on all devices. Do not create a duplicate. Ask the administrator to compare the cloud data and verified backups.

System does not open offline: Reconnect to the internet and open the official website. Offline access may require the site to have been loaded previously on that device.

Unexpected error after an update: Do not clear browser data or uninstall the browser before the administrator has checked whether unsynchronised local records need recovery.

9. Data privacy and good practice

• Use individual authorised access; do not share accounts.
• Lock the device when leaving it unattended.
• Do not send student lists, medical details, contacts or identification numbers through public groups.
• Do not use public or shared devices for sensitive records unless approved and properly secured.
• Report a lost device, suspected unauthorised access or accidental disclosure to the school administrator promptly.
• Follow the school's retention, access and data-protection policies.

10. Support and change control

For technical assistance, contact the designated school system administrator. Include the page/section, approximate time, device and browser, the message displayed, and the action taken. Do not send passwords, secret keys or full student records in an ordinary support message.

Only the authorised administrator should update the website files, Firebase configuration, Firestore rules, service worker or database structure. Keep a dated copy of the working version before every update.

End of preliminary manual

This manual should be revised after the fresh-install system has been deployed and each module has been checked on the actual screens.